

Unit – I**PART A - 2 Mark Questions****1. Define Encoding. (Jan 2015, Dec 18)**

It is the process of sharing information into some form of logical and coded message. Encoding message is based on the purpose of communication and the relation between the sender and the receiver.

- Selecting appropriate / proper language
- Selecting a medium of communication
- Selecting the form of communication

Selecting appropriate language is essential to decode the meaning/ message. Selecting the right medium of communication involves making the right choice out of many available options; it determines the effectiveness of encoding.

2. What is effective listening? (Jan 2015, April 17)

The attentive listening is interactive and productive, facilitating proper interactions and more effective listener – speaker relationships, it requires conscious effort on the part of the listener and demands concentration, involvement and responsibility. The effective listening may include all the types of listening in it. One should know how to develop the listening skill. Everyone needs to follow the six types of listening process. If they undergone the skills, they may get the entire listening skill with them.

3. What is communication? (Nov 15, Nov 17)

Communication is the process of sharing information. It is a dynamic interactive process that involves the effective transmission of facts, ideas, thoughts, feelings and values. Communication is an exchange of meaning and understanding. Meaning is central to the communication and transmission of meaning is the central objective of communication. It is symbolic because it involves not only words but also the symbols and gestures that accompany the spoken words.

4. What are the strategies involved in the process of communication? (Nov 16, April 17, April 18,)

Communication is a dynamic interactive process. It consists of five steps that are ideation, encoding, transmission, decoding and response.

Ideation: The process of communication begins with ideation, which refers to the formation of the idea or selection of a message to be communicated.

Encoding: Encoding is the next step in communication. It is the process of changing the information into some form of logical and coded message.

Transmission: Transmission refers to the flow of message over a chosen channel.

Decoding: Decoding is the process of converting message into thoughts by translating the received stimuli into an interpreted meaning in order to understand the message communicated.

Response: Response is the last stage of communication process. It is the action or reaction of the receiver to the message.

5. Write a note on the modes of communication. (May 19)

Interaction between the different individuals working in a company organization takes place through (i) formal and (ii) informal channels.

Formal communication has been classified as

- Downward communication
- Upward communication
- Horizontal communication and
- Diagonal communication

Informal communication has been classified as

- Single strand
- Gossip
- Cluster
- probability

6. What are the channels of communication? (Jan 2015)

Communication is essential for the internal function of any organization.

Communication can be broadly classified into formal and informal channels. Formal method in an organization is of four types.

- Downward communication
- Upward communication
- Horizontal communication
- Diagonal communication

Informal channels transmit of official news through unofficial and informal communicative interaction known as 'grape-vine'. This informal communication network includes teatime gossips, casual gatherings, lunch time, meetings and so on.

7. What is down ward communication? (April 16)

The main function of downward communication is providing direction and control; it refers to communication from the higher level in managerial hierarchy to

the lower ones. Communication from the general manager of a company to the branch manager is an example of downward communication. Downward communication is essential for the function of any organization as it involves the transfer of information, instructions, advice, request, feedback and ideas to subordinate staff.

8. Write the function of upward and horizontal communication.

Upward Communication: The main purpose of upward communication is to give feedback on several areas of organizational functioning. It refers to the communication from subordinates to superiors. A business report from the branch manager to the general manager of a company is an example of upward communication.

Horizontal Communication: The main objectives of horizontal communication are developing teamwork and promoting group coordination within an organization. It takes place between professional peer groups or people working on the same level of hierarchy.

9. What is diagonal communication? (Nov 2018)

Diagonal communication is the product of modern changes in information technology and management and is the result of the growing realization of fraternity and equality in the corporate sector. It is basically a response to market needs that demands speed and efficiency. It flows in all the directions.

10. What is Technical Communication? (Jan 16)

Technical communication is a central factor in the emerging society, where technocrats and professionals in different areas face new communication challenges. Technical communication is a transmission of technical and professional information from one individual or group to another. Effective technical communication is a dynamic interchange that may involve a systematic understanding of scientific and technical subjects.

11. What are the types of listening?

Listening is a conscious effort. Listening may be classified into the following six types on the basis of purpose and output:

1. Superficial listening
2. Appreciative listening
3. Focused listening
4. Evaluative listening

5. Attentive listening
6. Emphathetic listening.

12. Write short notes on the Attentive Listening.

Attentive listening demands the complete attention of the listener. It is basically active and intelligent listening in situations such as group discussion, meetings, job interviews and so on. The listener pays attention to all parts of the message that is, the central idea, main points, supporting details, examples and illustrations. There is no 'selective dismissal' of any part of the oral message.

13. What are the barriers to communication? (April 2016)

Barriers may emanate from either sender/ receiver or the circumstances of communication. There are several barriers to effective communication. That includes,

- Improper encoding
- Bypassing
- Frame of reference
- Physical distractions
- Psychological and emotional interference
- Cultural differences.

14. Explain the psychological barrier of listening.

The most common barriers to listening result from the listener who has disturbed state of mind. Any psychological or emotional disturbance can prove to be a barrier to effective listening because it leads to lack of interest and concentration. Over arousal of emotions like feelings of anger, frustration, sadness, anxiety or fears may effects the listeners ability of effective listening.

15. What are the barriers in the process of listening?

As listening is a complex process, it is desirable to take care of the barriers that may hamper the smooth flow of oral communication. Awareness of these barriers can help the listener adopt effective strategies to avoid them. The barriers of listening process may emanate from the speaker, listener, or the circumstances of communication. In oral communicative situations, any interference or noise that interferes with the listening process can create misunderstanding and confusion.

The following are the barriers of communication:

- ✓ Physical barriers

- ✓ Psychological barriers
- ✓ Linguistic barriers
- ✓ Cultural barriers

16. Describe the term “Bypassing”.

The term “Bye-spasing” refers to the misunderstanding resulting from missed meanings because of the use of abstract words and phrases on which both senders and receiver do not agree. Words mean different things to different people. Age, education and cultural background or three variables that influence the language a person uses. One should be familiar with concrete meanings so that there is no scope for confusion.

17. Write a short note on verbal and non-verbal communication.

Verbal communication can be classified into two types: oral and Written communication.

Non – Verbal communication can be classified into: body language, eye contact, facial expressions, gestures, postures and body movement.

18. Explain the intercultural differences in the barriers of communication.

The interpretation of meaning can create misunderstandings during intercultural communication because the sender and the receiver belong to different cultures and share different values. In fact, our values are our personal guides to our thought and behaviour, and exert a strong influence on us. We should be sensitive to cultural differences and take into account the values of listeners/ readers while communicating with them.

Part B - 5 or 6 Mark Questions

1. Write a note on the requirements of the Technical Communication. (Nov 16, Nov 18)

The three important requirement of technical communication

- Subject competence
- Linguistic competence
- Organizational competence

Subject competence: Ideation in the technical communication process depends on the sender’s subject competence, that is, his or her professional knowledge, experiences and ability.

Linguistic competence: Linguistic competence, on the, other hand is the possession of appropriate language skills and the ability to present scientific facts or information clearly and objectively.

Organizational competence: Organizational competence is the ability to organize technical information in a logical and structured way.

2. Explain the importance of the Accuracy, Brevity and Clarity in Technical Communication.

The first characteristic feature of Technical Communication is **Accuracy**, which includes accuracy of information as well as accuracy of expression. Accuracy of expressions demands punctuation or usage. Accuracy is essential for a professional and technical communicator.

Brevity is the quality of being brief but comprehensive in expression. Brevity can be achieved by avoiding wordiness and repetition. Therefore accuracy and brevity are important in TC.

Clarity in communication is the quality of being unambiguous and easily understood. Clarity can be achieved by using direct language, specific and concrete words and clear expressions.

3. What are the barriers to effective communication?(Nov 16, May 19)

Barriers may emanate from either the sender/ receiver or the circumstances of communication. There are several barriers to effective communication. That includes,

- Improper encoding
- Bypassing
- Frame of reference
- Physical distractions
- Psychological and emotional interference
- Cultural differences.

Improper Encoding: improper encoding is a recurrent barrier in the process of communication. Improper encoding occurs when the audience is not able to follow the language or dialect of the sender.

Bypassing: The term 'Bye-passing' refers to misunderstanding resulting from missed meanings because of the use of abstract words and phrases on which both senders and receiver do not agree.

Frame of reference: Your weakness in viewing others within your frame of reference may lead to confusion and misunderstanding.

Physical distractions: It can easily disrupt communication.

Psychological and Emotional interferences: Feelings of sadness, fear, anger, anxiety or jubilation, influence our reception and receptivity to other's ideas can prove to be a barrier to effective communication.

Intercultural difference: The interpretation of meaning can create misunderstanding during intercultural communication because the sender and the receiver belong to different cultures and share different values.

4. Write the difference between General and Technical communication? (April 17, May 19)

General Communication	Technical Communication
General content	Technical content
General vocabulary	Specialized vocabulary
No formal elements	Formal elements
Both formal and informal in style	Always formal in style
May not be formal	Always formal
Both objective and subjective	Objective only
Not always structured	Logically organized and structured
No specific exposition techniques	Complex and important exposition techniques
Not always for a specific audience	Specific audience
May or may not involve graphics	Usually involves graphics

5. What are the barriers for listening? Explain in detail. (April 17, April 18)

Barriers to listening include physical distractions, psychological or emotional disturbance, linguistic and cultural barriers.

Physical distractions: Physical distractions and disturbances can easily disrupt the process of listening. Barriers to listening could be noise, physical discomfort or any physical factors.

Psychological barrier: Psychological or emotional disturbance can prove to be a barrier to effective listening because it leads to lack of interest and concentration.

Linguistic barrier: If the message is decoded incorrectly by the listener or sender, it may lead to confusion and misunderstanding.

Cultural barrier: If the speaker and listener belong to different cultures and share different values, listening could become a difficult process.

6. What are the strategies for effective communication?

To develop strategies for effective communication, it requires seven Cs and four S.

Seven Cs

1. Courtesy – friendly and helpful behaviour towards others.

2. **Clarity** – requires proper encoding of the message and choice of appropriate words.
3. **Conciseness** – avoid irrelevant words and repetitions.
4. **Concreteness** – creates visual images they are easy to register.
5. **Correctness** – correct use of grammar and correct words.
6. **Consideration** – attitude should be maintained while communicating.
7. **Completeness** – content and style should be proper.

Four – S

1. **Shortness** – to avoid sentence which are very long.
2. **Simplicity** – the simpler the message the easier it is to comprehend.
3. **Strength** – to find out the fact that there is something substantial about the message.
4. **Sincerity** – the impact of the message to be genuine and long lasting

7. What are the types of listening? Explain in brief. (April 17, Nov 18)

Listening is a conscious effort. Listening may be classified into the following six types on the basis of purpose and output:

- Superficial listening
- Appreciative listening
- Focused listening
- Evaluative listening
- Attentive listening
- Emphathetic listening.

Superficial listening: The listener has little awareness of the content of what is being said.

Appreciative Listening: The main purpose of this listening is to get enjoyment or pleasure.

Focused listening : It involves listening for specific information.

Evaluative listening: Evaluative listening involves evaluation of the oral message or commentary and developing a line of thought.

Attentive listening: It demands the complete attention of the listener.

Emphathetic listening: Emphathetic listening is listening not only to what the speaker is saying but also to how he/she is saying that is his/her feelings, emotions and state of mind.

8. Write a short note on listening process. (April 18)

Hearing happens automatically while listening requires conscious effort. Listening could be superficial, appreciative, focused, evaluative, attentive and empathetic depending on its purpose and output. We listen to different kinds of oral message for different purposes.

Difference between Hearing and Listening

Hearing	Listening
In voluntary	Voluntary
Happens automatically	Requires conscious effort
Passive process	Active process
One way process	Two way interactive process

Stages of Listening

Listening is a conscious effort. The four stages of listening are:

- ❖ Sensing
- ❖ Message decoding/ interpretation
- ❖ Evaluation
- ❖ Response

Types of Listening

- Superficial listening
- Appreciative listening
- Focused listening
- Evaluative listening
- Attentive listening
- Empathetic listening

Part B - Straight 11 Mark Question

1. How to develop an effective listening skill? (April 17, April 18, Nov 19, May 19)

Ten thumb rules for good listening:

1. Stop talking:

Do not talk while listening. One cannot be a speaker and a listener at the same time. The listener should accept his/her role and allow the speaker to talk.

2. Stop thinking:

Do not think while listening. One cannot be a speaker and a listener at the same time. The listener should accept his/her role and allow the speaker to talk.

3. Remove Distractions:

In order to focus 100 percent on the person speaking, the listener should avoid all kinds of distractions.

4. Do not let your mind wander:

In order to get concentration on each word spoken by the speaker the listener must keep his mind with him.

5. Put speaker at ease:

A favorable environment should be provided to the speaker in order to enable him to speak comfortably.

6. Do not Pre-judge:

Pre Judgment closes the mind and does not allow you to perceive the speaker.

7. Be Patient:

Patience is the key to good listening. The speaker should be allowed sufficient time and no interruptions should be there until the speaker takes a pause and invites and the listener to do so.

8. Do not be Angry:

The listener should control his/her temper while listening. Good listening demands listening calmly without making any fuss.

9. Empathise with the speaker:

In order to understand the speaker's perspective and appreciate his point of view, the listener should try to put him in the speaker position.

10. Take notes:

The listener should take notes if he wants to keep a record of what was said and wants to use it at a later stage.

2. Highlight the importance of communication skills in a student's life. (April 18)

Communication is the process of sharing information. It is dynamic interactive process that involves the effective transmission of facts, ideas, thoughts, feelings and values. Communication is an exchange of meaning and understanding. Meaning is central to communication and transmission of meaning is the central objectives of communication. It is symbolic because it involves not only words but also symbols and gestures that accompany the spoken words.

Communication is one of the essential conditions of social interaction. It becomes a process of sharing information that pervades the entire range.

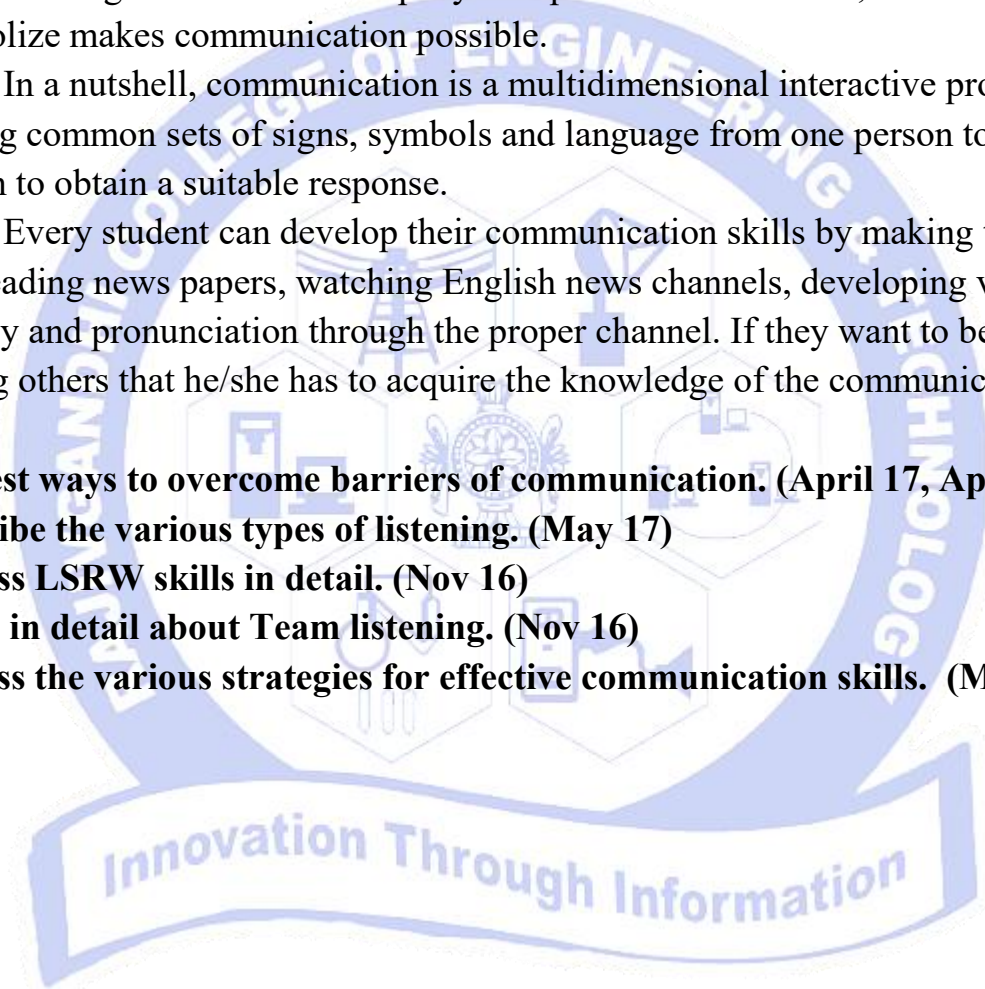
The term “communication” per se is derived from the Latin word “communicare” meaning to share, to impart or to commune. Its literal meaning is giving/sharing information.

In this dynamic process ‘meaning’ plays a crucial part, ‘transmission of meaning’ is the central objective of communication. Communication begins with the sender sending out message cues, which are perceived by the receiver, who assign meaning to them and responds to them accordingly. Communication is not complete unless the message is decoded and understood it involves not only words but also symbols and gestures that accompany the spoken words. In fact, our ability to symbolize makes communication possible.

In a nutshell, communication is a multidimensional interactive process of sharing common sets of signs, symbols and language from one person to another person to obtain a suitable response.

Every student can develop their communication skills by making the practices like reading news papers, watching English news channels, developing vocabulary, fluency and pronunciation through the proper channel. If they want to be unique among others that he/she has to acquire the knowledge of the communication skill.

- 3. Suggest ways to overcome barriers of communication. (April 17, April 18)**
- 4. Describe the various types of listening. (May 17)**
- 5. Discuss LSRW skills in detail. (Nov 16)**
- 6. Write in detail about Team listening. (Nov 16)**
- 7. Discuss the various strategies for effective communication skills. (May 19)**



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